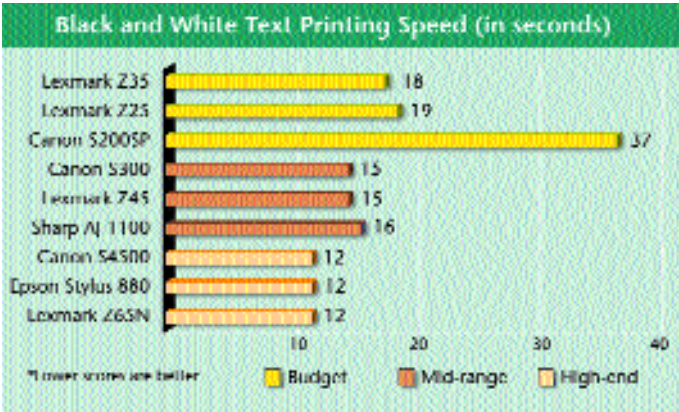


white test page in under a minute. But if you want a low-priced printer that can churn out black and white prints on plain paper really fast, then look no further than the Lexmark Z35—it spat out our test page in 18 seconds flat. The Lexmark Z25 was also fast, taking just one extra second to print this document. The Lexmark Z13, on the other hand, took a whopping 102 seconds (1 minute 42 seconds) to print the test page.

In the photo printout test, the Canon BJC-2100SP came out trumps. It finished printing our colour test photo in less than 9 minutes (8 minutes 50 seconds) and took just over a minute (1 minute 5 seconds) to print the greyscale version of the same photo. However, the other Canon entry in the budget segment, the S200SP, was the slowest—it took more than 19 minutes to print the test image! The HP Deskjet 656C was the only printer that could match the pace of the Canon BJC-2100SP in the colour photo test printout; it printed the colour photo in a neat 9 minutes 8 seconds.

Hence, if your print jobs consist of large amounts of text and diagrams in greyscale mode, then the Lexmark Z35 is the best option for you. On the other hand, if you need to print full colour photos as fast as possible, nothing comes close to the Canon BJC-2100SP in this category.

Almost all the printers in the mid-range category could print our test text document in less than 30 seconds. The fastest were the Canon S300 and the Lexmark Z45—both took only 15 seconds. Close on their heels was the Sharp AJ-1100, which took 16 seconds to finish the print. The only sore thumb in this category was the Olivetti Artjet 22, which took a sluggish 1 minute 33 seconds to finish the text print.



In the colour photo print test, the fastest was once again the Canon S300 (3 minutes 38 seconds). The HP Deskjet 948C came in a close second, taking 3 minutes 57 seconds. In fact, this printer logged pretty decent scores in the speed test for black and white text printing also and if you have a fair quantum of text and colour graphics-based print jobs, then this one gives you adequate speed for both.

The Lexmark Z45 failed to live up to the numbers it posted in the text printout; it took 9 minutes 40 seconds to print the colour photo. A similar trend was observed for the other Lexmark printers too—they are able to print text fairly fast, but are rather sluggish in printing colour. The Lexmark Z45 seems pretty fine-tuned for heavy text and black and white printing and this becomes all the more apparent when you observe the scores for greyscale photo printing (an amazing 48 seconds). The rest languished with scores over a minute for the greyscale test.

Speed is where the high-end printers come into their own because of their advanced print electronics and mechanics. In a

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